

POSC 3050 - CREATIVE INQUIRY: GLOBALIZATION AND POLITICAL COMPETITION

Section 017

Thu 5:00-6:00 pm | Bracket 234

Instructor: Alex Honeker**Email:** [jhoneyke@clemson.edu](mailto:jhoneke@clemson.edu)**Office:** Bracket 231-A**Office Hours:** Mon/Wed 1:00-2:00 pm, Tue/Thu 3:45-4:45 pm. If these times do not work for you, please send me an email and we can find another time to meet.**COURSE OVERVIEW**

This Creative Inquiry project examines how globalization affects (and is influenced by) political competition at both the domestic and international levels. After several decades of deepening economic integration, the global economy has recently entered a period of rising uncertainty and decreased cooperation. Whether this trend reflects a true shift toward de-globalization or merely a phase of “slowbalization” remains an open question.

Students in this project will conduct research on topics such as:

- domestic competition between internationalist and nationalist political parties;
- interest-group conflict over trade and migration;
- geopolitical competition in trade, investment, and supply chains;
- and other political dynamics linked to globalization.

Students will research questions such as: How has globalization influenced party competition in democracies? Which factors influence voters' views on trade and immigration? What role do interest groups (business, labor) play? How does geopolitical competition affect trade and investment flows? The project provides training in social science research methods, including how to formulate research questions, collect and analyze data, and present findings. Students will produce a research poster suitable for presentation at an academic conference.

This Creative Inquiry is structured as a mentored undergraduate research experience. Students will work closely with the instructor and their peers to develop original research projects, receive continuous feedback, and engage in collaborative problem-solving typical of academic research teams.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Identify a research question.
- Conduct a review of scientific literature.
- Develop a theory and testable hypotheses.
- Identify data sources.
- Analyze data and empirically test relationships between variables.

The project will also provide an opportunity to critically analyze contemporary challenges in global politics such as liberal democratic backsliding, polarization, zero-sum politics, populism, and geopolitical tensions.

COURSE PREREQUISITES

The project is aimed at students in the social and behavioral sciences (political science, economics, psychology, sociology). Some background knowledge in these fields is strongly recommended.

REQUIRED MATERIALS

All mandatory reading materials will be posted by the instructor on Canvas or shared via email.

REQUIRED SOFTWARE

We will use the R programming language to conduct statistical analysis and visualize data. Students will need to download “**R**” and “**R Studio**” on their laptops. This software is freely available online. We will go over how to do this in our meetings. No prior experience with R is required. The focus will be on learning enough to analyze data relevant to your project rather than on advanced programming.

GRADING SCALE

Letter grades will be determined in the following way:

A = 90-100	B = 80-89.99	C = 70-79.99	D = 60-69.99	F = <60
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EVALUATION CRITERIA

Your grade will consist of the following components:

1. Engagement **35%**
2. Attendance **15%**
3. Research Project **50%**

1. **Engagement.** You are expected to actively participate in class discussions. If you have reading assignments, you are expected to read the assigned materials prior to our meetings. A big part of this course will involve discussion of your research projects. This will include reviewing and critiquing your classmates' work in a thoughtful way and providing constructive feedback. Engagement is evaluated separately from attendance and reflects the quality of participation, preparation, and feedback provided to peers, not merely presence.
2. **Attendance.** You are expected to attend our weekly meetings. Excused absences should be notified to me before our meeting in order to avoid losing points.
3. **Research Project.** This is an experiential and research-driven course, so the main component of your grade will be your work towards developing a research project throughout the semester, including a research question, a literature review, a theory and testable hypotheses, and an empirical strategy. You are not expected to finish the project in one semester, but you should make significant progress and incorporate the feedback received in our weekly meetings. You should be able to produce a research poster suitable for presentation at an academic conference by the end of the second semester. The research project can be conducted individually or with other classmates if you have similar research interests.

TIME COMMITMENT

As a 1-credit Creative Inquiry, this course is designed to require approximately 3 hours of work per week (1 hour of a meeting and 2 hours of independent research activities and preparation).

CLASSROOM CONDUCT

Students are expected not to engage in any behavior that may disrupt the learning process. Students are encouraged to actively participate in an environment of free and open exchange of ideas and mutual respect. Any kind of disrespect towards another individual will not be tolerated.

UNIVERSITY POLICIES

You can find information about campus wide policies, including student affairs information and accessibility services, by clicking on Clemson's University Policies Page. There, you can find information about academic integrity, access and equity (including student accessibility and Title IX info), student financial services, emergency planning, and more. My expectation is that you will review these policies carefully and be responsible for them this semester.

STUDENT ACCESSIBILITY SERVICES.

Clemson University values the diversity of our student body as a strength and a critical component of our dynamic community. Students with disabilities or temporary injuries/conditions may require accommodations due to barriers in the structure of facilities, course design, technology used for curricular purposes, or other campus resources. Students who experience a barrier to full access to this class should let the instructor know and make an appointment to meet with a staff member in Student Accessibility Services as soon as possible. You can make an appointment by calling 864-656-6848, by emailing CUSAS@clemson.edu, or by visiting Suite 239 in the Academic Success Center building. Appointments are strongly encouraged – drop-ins will be seen, if at all possible, but there could be a significant wait due to scheduled appointments. Students who have accommodations are strongly encouraged to request, obtain, and send these to their instructors via SAS as early in the semester as possible so that accommodations can be made in a timely manner. It is the student's responsibility to follow this process each semester.

TITLE IX.

The Clemson University Title IX statement: Clemson University is committed to creating and continuously fostering a caring community based on the core values of integrity, honesty and respect. Sexual discrimination, which includes sexual harassment, sexual violence, stalking and domestic and/or relationship violence, is unacceptable and has no place in Clemson's community. Consistent with its Title IX obligation, the University prohibits discrimination, including sexual and gender-based harassment and violence, in all its programs and activities, including academics, employment, athletics, and other extracurricular activities. This Title IX policy is available online. Katherine Weathers is

the Clemson University Title IX Coordinator and VP of Inclusive Excellence. She can be reached at (864) 656-3413 or via email at kweath3@clemson.edu. Remember, email is not a fully secured method of communication and should not be used to discuss Title IX issues.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY.

As members of the Clemson University community, we have inherited Thomas Green Clemson's vision of this institution as a "high seminary of learning." Fundamental to this vision is a mutual commitment to truthfulness, honor, and responsibility, without which we cannot earn the trust and respect of others. Furthermore, we recognize that academic dishonesty detracts from the value of a Clemson degree. Therefore, we shall not tolerate lying, cheating, or stealing in any form. Using materials generated using artificial intelligence (AI) that are turned in without attribution is considered plagiarism. All infractions of academic dishonesty by undergraduates must be reported to Undergraduate Studies for resolution through that office. In cases of plagiarism instructors may use the Plagiarism Resolution Form. See the following resources: [Undergraduate Academic Integrity Policy](#).

TECH SUPPORT.

If you have trouble with Canvas or another university system, check here first: Clemson System Status. There, you can see if there is a current issue and when it might be resolved. If there's no current issue listed, try logging out and quitting your browser before trying again. You can also look in the Canvas Help Guides for more information. The CCIT Support Center at Clemson offers a wide range of support options and hardware repair with several contact methods to help you answer your questions as quickly as possible:

- Phone: (864) 656-3494
- Email: ITHelp@clemson.edu
- Entire catalog of IT services, including an online chat and the Knowledge Base at: [IT Help and Support](#).

Officially, Canvas supports all the major web browsers: Chrome, Firefox, Edge, and Safari. However, Safari is not fully compatible; images often do not show up in Safari, so Clemson Online recommends against using it with Canvas. Canvas also has mobile apps available for teachers, students, and parents, all of which can be found in your mobile device's app store. These apps are convenient, but do not necessarily display or connect to every component of a Canvas site. They are good for assignment reminders, announcements, and messaging, but not as good for reading materials, taking exams, or building elements.

ONLINE TESTING.

By enrolling in a course with online assessments, the student agrees and consents to the use of an online test proctoring service or software program as described above. The student also agrees to allowing the student, their activity, and surrounding workspace to be recorded by video and audio and then analyzed by the test proctoring system, the course instructor, and others at Clemson University. For more information see the Academic Regulations section of the Undergraduate Catalog.

EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS STATEMENT.

Emergency procedures can be found on the Clemson University Emergency Management website and in the purple-covered flipbooks located in offices and classrooms through campus. Students and employees should ensure they are signed up to receive CU Alert text messages, familiarize themselves with emergency procedures and follow all directions from emergency responders in the event of an emergency. More information about safety resources available at Clemson University can be found at Clemson.edu/CUSafety.

ACADEMIC SUCCESS CENTER.

The Academic Success Center (ASC) offers a variety of free learning and success services for all undergraduate students that include:

Mastery of course content:

- Tutoring – students can expect a 1:1 meeting with a trained undergraduate peer leader (who made an A or B in the course and was recommended by a faculty member) during which the student can share specific questions they have about course content with the tutor focused on helping the student, through questioning techniques and identification of helpful learning strategies, and master course concepts. Tutors do not help with homework or other class assignments.
- Peer-Assisted Learning (PAL) – students can expect collaborative and active group learning and study sessions focused on mastery of course content and learning strategies that is facilitated by a trained undergraduate peer leader (who made an A or B in the course and was recommended by a faculty member). PAL leaders do not help with homework or other class assignments.

Learning and Success Strategies:

- Academic coaching – students can expect a 1:1 meeting with a trained professional academic coach during which the coach helps students see themselves, their skills, and their study habits from a fresh perspective through one-on-one sessions focused on learning and personal success strategies.

- Success strategy workshops – students can expect 30-45 minute workshops on college success skills, time management and organizational skills, test-taking strategies, study strategies, finals preparation, life skills, and academic resources.
- CU 2100 (Academic Resilience and Success Skills Course) - students experiencing academic difficulty can expect a course focused on academic and personal skill building to help them improve their academic standing.

ASC services are designed to equip students with strategies and resources they can use to:

- Succeed in their courses
- Become more confident, independent, and skillful learners
- Engage in more productive and effective study and learning strategies
- Manage their time more effectively

Location: The Class of 1956 Academic Success Center building is located in the center of campus adjacent to Cooper Library and the Watt Family Innovation Center.

CLEMSON LIBRARIES.

Do you need academic sources but don't know where to start? Don't spend hours searching on your own – ask a librarian! The Libraries provide time saving online guides for subject areas that can help you find articles, databases, books and more. Personalized research assistance with librarians who specialize in subject areas is available by appointment. Help is available in person at each of our many locations and you can also chat with a librarian live from our website, or text 864.762.4884.

Do you need to verify a book, article, or data set suggested by AI to support your research or paper? You can check out the online catalog, use the Libraries AI Research Assistant, use verified AI research tools embedded in databases like JSTOR and EBSCO, or chat with a librarian for quick help. There is also an online guide about AI Tools for Research and a 10 Step AI Challenge that you can explore to find out more about AI tools.

Not sure how to cite a source properly in your bibliography? There are online guides to help you with any citation style as well as citation management tools available for Clemson students: RefWorks & Endnote. There are also interactive online courses with tips to help you understand and avoid plagiarism.

Working on a creative project like creating a video or 3D object? For assistance with digital and hands-on creative projects, the Adobe Studio and Makerspace is located

on the 5th floor of Cooper Library and is staffed with experts who can help turn your creative ideas into reality. You can even check out many different kinds of equipment like high resolution cameras, green screens, and projectors from our library services desk in Cooper Library.

Need help making a chart or graph to help visualize your data? The Data Visualization Lab on the 4th floor of Cooper provides support for data visualization, data analysis, and digital research methods.

No matter what your research needs, check out what the Clemson Libraries have to offer! www.libraries.clemson.edu

CLEMSON WRITING LAB.

The Writing Lab is a valuable resource available to all students in this course. It offers individualized assistance to help you strengthen your writing skills and enhance the quality of your written assignments. Whether you need help with brainstorming ideas, organizing your thoughts, developing a thesis statement, improving grammar and punctuation, or any other aspect of writing, the Writing Lab consultants are there to support you. Appointments can be scheduled online, and walk-in sessions may also be available. You can learn more on their website: www.clemson.edu/writing-lab. Use of the Writing Lab is encouraged as it is a valuable resource to develop your writing abilities and improve your academic performance. The Writing Lab is located on the third floor of Cooper Library.